Ashley Roots

Digital learning leader, UK further and higher education

LEARNING DESIGN / PLATFORMS / CODE

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I lead a remote team across Digital Education, Library Services and Timetabling at ACM, setting direction for online and blended learning, the Canvas VLE and the tools around it. With an MA in Education, a PGCE and hands-on front-end and Python skills, I keep strategy grounded in what platforms can do and what learners need.

HIGHLIGHT
IHE AWARDS 2026

Shortlisted for Technology Enhanced Learning for ACM's shared Skills Library, which I designed, led and built. It holds over 100 modules from across the institution, open to students on any pathway, and keeps growing.

01 — EXPERIENCE

Head of Academic Operations and Digital Teams

ACM · January 2026 – present

- Lead and line manage a remote team of five across Digital Education (learning design and development, and learning technology), Library Services and Timetabling.
- Own the Canvas VLE and wider digital infrastructure, including integrations that create Zoom sessions automatically, and report departmental performance to the senior leadership team.
- Introduced online content sign-off covering technical and pedagogical standards, and QA oversight of staff and student enrolments.
- Built new Canvas course homepages that read each student's enrolments to show their own courses, with automated content lists. Now testing list, drop-down and tile layouts with students, timing how quickly they find resources.
- Designed and built pathway hubs: one for each of seven music pathways, and a shared collaborative hub for five games pathways.
- Run digital credentials through Parchment (previously Accredible), using a Python tool I built to match assessment results against Canvas engagement and prepare bulk awards.
- Developing Python tools for academic operations: a Canvas dashboard for course inventory, bulk Blueprint management and licence reconciliation, and a course package extractor for archiving.

SKILLS

Leadership

- Digital learning strategy
- Team leadership
- Stakeholder engagement
- Data and reporting

Learning design

- Experience design
- Digital pedagogy
- Curriculum design
- Accessibility

Platforms

- Canvas architecture
- Digital quality assurance
- Digital credentials
- Project management

Code

- HTML, CSS, JavaScript
- Canvas APIs
- Python automation
- Google Apps Script

RECOGNITION

Fellowship of the Higher Education Academy (FHEA)
Application in progress

01 — EXPERIENCE, CONTINUED

Lead Learning Developer

ACM · Remote · January 2022 – December 2025

- Built the online content for a new degree programme, largely single-handed.
- Developed and maintained custom JavaScript and CSS extending Canvas functionality and accessibility.
- Established ACM's online learning pedagogy framework to guide digital learning initiatives.
- Designed digital learning with teaching staff, learning technologists and external experts, and managed the platforms that deliver it.

Teaching, Learning and Assessment Coach

Burton and South Derbyshire College · January 2019 – December 2021

- Led the design of blended courses, expanding the college's distance learning offer.
- Migrated the intranet to SharePoint, improving accessibility and the user experience.
- Trained staff in the digital skills needed for effective remote delivery.

Music Performance and Technology Tutor

Confetti Institute of Creative Technologies, Nottingham · August 2013 – December 2018

- Taught and developed Level 1–3 music curricula, including online and blended resources.
- Led internal verification, receiving highly commended feedback from external verifiers on course content and delivery.

02 — EDUCATION

MA Education

University of Derby · 2018 – 2020

Dissertation on using video technologies to improve face-to-face teaching.

PGCE

University of Derby · 2012 – 2013

BA (Hons) Music Management and Studio Production

Buckinghamshire New University · 2008 – 2011

TRAINING

- Web Development Bootcamp
- Microsoft Office Specialist
- Microsoft Innovative Educator
- Apple Teacher
- EDI Champion

INTERESTS

Music, gaming, miniature painting and front-end side projects.

REFERENCES

Available on request.